Fern's Voice Training!

Fern Sprouse

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Pracitce Checklist

- ☐ Complete exercises
- ☐ Speak sentences into a spectrograph
- ☐ Take a recording and listen

Warm-up

Belly Breathing

Place one hand on your chest and one hand on your belly.

- **Inhale**: Breathe in through your nose. Think about breathing low to fill up the bottom of your lungs. As you breathe in you should feel your belly press out and/or your ribs expand to the sides. The hand on your chest should stay relatively still.
- **Exhale**: Breathe out with pursed lips. As you breathe out gently contract your abdominals. Think about pressing the air up from below as you exhale.

Cup Bubbles

Take a relaxed breath in, then blow slowly for 5 to 10 seconds into a straw to make bubbles in a cup of water. Hum while exhaling and try to move the hum to the front of the mouth. Slide the pitch of the hum sound up and down with steady control.

MMM Sounds

Hold a hum sound for 5 to 8 seconds. Try to notice the forward vibration on your lips. Then, say the following syllables.

- Me Me
- May May
- My My
- Moe Moe
- Moo Moo

Sustained "Ahh"

Take a deep breath and hold a strong, clear "Ahh" for at least 10 seconds.

Glides with "Ahh"

Take a deep breath and glide from a low but comfortable baseline up in pitch with a strong, clear "Ahh".

Phonation

Easy Onset Practice

Say the following word pairs. At the second word, try to mimic the feeling of using air to begin the sound instead of a hard start.

- hail, ale
- hair, air
- hall, all
- ham, am
- harm, arm
- has, as
- hear, ear
- heat, eat
- heel, eel
- high, I
- hike, Ike
- hill, ill
- hit, it
- hive, I've
- how, ow

Easy Onset Sentences

Say the following sentences with relaxed voicing.

- Our Aunt Alice is always angry.
- It is impossible to understand arithmetic.
- Eryn's umbrella is under the overhang.
- Astronauts are unbelievably ambitious.
- Everyone asks if Amy is my aunt.
- I'll have already eaten enough oatmeal.
- Emma is an unusually artistic adolescent.
- If you enter early, attendandts are available in the aisles.
- Actors arrive at the awards in expensive attire.
- Accountants are always extremely accurate.
- Erica and Ivana are always at the opera.
- Olivia was embarassed by all of Alice's attention.
- It was an eye-opening experience for Allison.
- It is an effort to understand Aunt Alice's accent.
- Olivia's used automobiles are usually under eight thousand dollars.

Resonance

As in the Warm-up, start each word with a hum sound and carry it through without letting your voice drop into your throat.

M — One-syllable Words

- mad
- made
- mail
- main
- make
- mall
- malt
- man
- map
- mare
- mark
- mash
- mask
- match
- may
- meal
- mean
- meet
- meek
- melt
- merge
- mess
- met
- mild
- mile
- milk
- mind
- mine
- mink
- mint
- mist
- mix
- mob
- mode
- mold
- mole
- mom
- monk
- month
- mood
- moon
- moose
- mop
- more
- moss
- most
- moth
- mound
- mourn
- mouse
- mouth
- move
- munch
- must
- my

M — Two-syllable Words

- machine
- magic
- maiden
- mailbag
- major
- mango
- manmade
- maple
- market
- marshall
- mascot
- master
- matchbox
- measure
- meatloaf
- melon
- melted
- member
- memo
- menace
- merger
- merit
- messy
- metric
- middle
- mighty
- million
- mindless
- minute
- misread
- mitten
- mixer
- mobile
- model
- mohawk
- moldy
- molten
- monarch
- money
- monkey
- monster
- moody
- moonbeam
- morning
- mouthpiece
- movie
- mower
- muscle
- music
- musty
- myself

M — Sentences

- Meet my mom.
- Mix mint milk.
- Merge more movies.
- Moths make a mess.
- March for a mile.
- Mark my mailbag.
- Make maple malt.
- Mean marketers mumble.
- Munch on mushy melons.
- March on Main Street.
- Meet the man at the metal mine.
- Measure a million miles.
- Muddy mowers make a mess.
- Master movers never mess up.
- Metric machines mean more money.
- Mark the message before I move.
- Mom melted my magic mascot.
- Middle school menaces are mean.
- Musicians' mouthpieces make music.
- Monsters move in the moonbeams.
- My mouse and monkey wear mini mittens.
- Members made mobiles with modern matchboxes.
- Monarchs love misty mangos in the morning.
- Mountain climbers are mystified by monumental peaks.
- Mounds of mud messed up the merging motorists.
- Moss and mold are not manmade materials.
- Markets in Montana collect money from mountaineers.
- Mysterious marble is magnified with a microscope.
- Marathon runners move quickly on the last mile.
- Miniature mice made a home in my mousetrap.

Intonation

Statement or Question

Say each sentence twice, once as a statement and once as a question. Use falling and rising pitch to differentiate the two respectively.

- Mae wants to go the park.
- I have to pay my bills on Wednesday.
- Her mother's name is Fern.
- Tomorrow we will have a party.
- There is no more room in this pantry.
- Someone is knocking at the door.
- Your prom dress is lavender.
- It is too late to call her at home.
- Kimberly's cat has had kittens.

Words

For each of the following sentences, read them once in the way that sounds natural. Then, use pitch inflection to stress each noun as though responding to a question.

- My dog's name is Mae.
- Ria goes to university in Boston.
- I have to work too damn early for too freaking long.
- Skylar often cooks excellent meals.
- Indiana would like a silver necklace for graduation.
- Eryn filled her basement with ventilation ducts.